



PCs lying about their disk space? Refusing to talk sans a password? Here's how you get them to behave!

Auto-power does not work

Q. I have a few problems. Recently, I installed Windows XP Professional alongside Windows 98. Now, I see three options in the boot menu: Windows XP Professional, Windows XP Professional and WINDOWS 98. How do I remove that extra Windows XP option? By the way, XP is loaded in C:\Windows.000 and 98 in D:\Windows.

Also, the machine doesn't power off automatically when using Windows XP. This is not so with Windows 98. As I have an ATX power supply, I guess by default it should turn off automatically. Please help me solve these problems.

Tapas Kumar Mahata

A. For your first problem, open the file c:\boot.ini using Notepad. You will observe that it has two rows with Windows XP Professional mentioned. Keep the following line:

multi(w)disk(x)rdisk(y) partition(z)\windows.000="Microsoft Windows XP Professional"

Delete the other row, save the file and restart your PC.

As for your second problem, you need to enable Advanced Power Management (APM) for your system. To do so, go to **Control Panel > Power Options**. Here, click on the APM tab and select 'Enable Advanced Power Management support'. Once done, your PC should shutdown automatically.

program is needed for opening files of type 'Application'. Location of SirC32.exe.C:\'. The error message box has three buttons: OK, Cancel and Locate. What should I do?

Ashwin Doshi

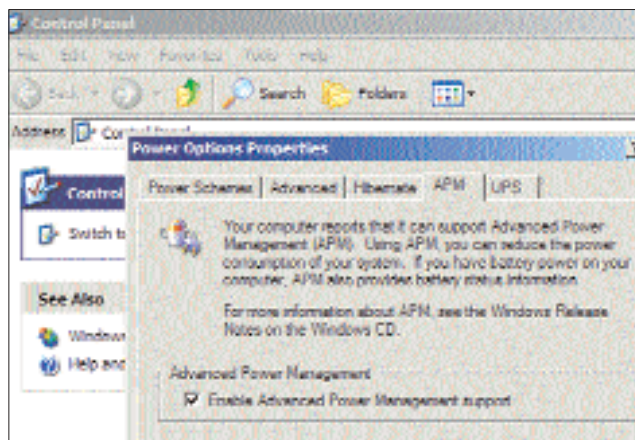
A. The filename is that of a virus that infected your PC. Norton scanned the machine and deleted it. However, its residue effect is still present and that is the cause of the error message. The simplest way out is to download and execute the virus fix. Norton has one such fix available at <http://www.sarc.com/avcenter/FixSirC.exe>.

Connecting computers in the same locality

Q. I have a Pentium 4 2.6 GHz, 512 MB RAM and a GeForce4 128 MB video card. My friend also has the same configuration. We would like to play multiplayer games, but our Internet connection is too slow. Is there any hardware upgrade possible that will connect our PCs directly? We would prefer something that does not need a telephone line. My friend's house is just a five-minute walk away from mine. Also, do let us know the costs involved.

Rahul

A. You will get a better performance if you connect to your friend's computer →



Check the 'Enable Advanced Power Management support' option to take advantage of APM and at the same time save on electricity bills!

Files deleted by anti-virus software

Q. I have a Windows 98 PC that uses a Cyrix Media GX processor, 64 MB RAM and runs Norton AntiVirus Software. It deleted certain files while scanning for viruses. Soon after that, several programs failed to open and I get the following error:

'Program not found. Windows can not find SirC32.exe. This